The scallops are a counterpoint to the distinctive taste of the Jerusalem artichoke purée in this traditional soup menu pairing.

scallop and artichoke soup

SERVES 4 **PREP** 20 MINS **COOK** 25 MINS **FREEZE** UP TO 3 MONTHS
AT THE END OF STEP 1

7 tbsp unsalted butter
1 onion, chopped
1 garlic clove, chopped
2¼lb (1kg) Jerusalem artichokes, peeled or scrubbed and cut into small dice
1½ quarts (1½ liters) hot chicken stock or water
½ cup heavy cream
salt and freshly ground black pepper
a pinch of freshly grated nutmeg
4 thick slices bacon, cut into small dice
4 scallops
2 tbsp sunflower oil
few drops of lemon juice
snipped chives, to garnish

1 Melt 3½ tbsp butter in a large pan and cook the onion gently. Add the garlic and artichokes and sweat over low heat for 3 minutes. Add the stock or water, cover with a lid, and simmer until the artichokes are completely cooked and soft. Purée in a blender with the cream and the remaining butter. You may need to do this in batches. Return to the pan and season with salt and freshly ground black pepper, then sprinkle in the nutmeg and keep warm.

2 Cook the bacon in a frying pan until crisp, then spoon on to paper towels to drain. Season the scallops with salt and freshly ground black pepper, then cook quickly in the sunflower oil—they will be ready almost as soon as they are sealed by the heat. Squeeze a few drops of lemon juice over the top.

3 Divide the artichoke purée among four bowls, spoon the bacon and scallops on top, then garnish with the chives and serve.